

# GREGORY THE GREAT INSTITUTE
## 2026 IMPACT REPORT

FIDES ✝ RATIO ✝ CULTURA

# DIRECTOR'S YEAR IN REVIEW LETTER

2026



**A Year of Consolidation and Growth**

This year marked a season of intense growth. The Gregory the Great Institute moved from laying foundations to developing leaders, producing content, and expanding our reach across Canada.

The year opened strong. In January, we surpassed our 2026 fundraising goal, a testimony to the growing confidence of our supporters and the fruit of relationships built over the previous year. With funding secured, we turned our full attention to programs.

Our book studies program expanded, drawing over 100 groups of friends into a sustained encounter with the Catholic intellectual tradition. We hosted our first marriage retreat, bringing together couples seeking to root their vocations more deeply in faith and culture. We launched our first master class on personal finances, promoting wise stewardship as a strong foundation for married life.

Our summer programs brought much joy. St. Gregory's Folk and Sacred Music Camp grew dramatically, forming future music leaders drawn from 18 different parishes. Our invite-only Faith and Reason Seminar for Professionals continued to gather Catholic leaders for reflection on philosophical themes. This year's theme, "The Next Christendom," drew participants together four days of Socratic seminars around texts by Aristotle, Augustine, Chaucer, papal writings, and more. Our summer interns joined us, bringing youthful energy and talent to the work of cultural renewal.

Perhaps our most ambitious undertaking this year was filming and producing "Reasonable Passions," a 12-part series exploring the role of faith in shaping Western civilization. This project represents a new chapter for the Institute, bringing our mission to many who may never attend a conference or join a book study but who are hungry for truth beautifully told. To date our videos have gained over 2 million views.

This fall, we upgraded our website, gained registered charity status with the CRA, and hosted another sold-out second Annual Renewing Culture Conference around the theme of "Bringing Back Sunday."

Looking ahead, we enter 2027 with a clear mandate: to deepen what we have built, to reach further, and to form more leaders for the long work of renewing culture in Canada.

Thank you for making this possible. All of these works depend upon your generosity, your prayer, and your shared conviction that faith and reason together can help rebuild a thriving culture.

May the God who began this good work in us bring it to completion (cf. Philippians 1:6).

Dr. Ryan N.S. Topping
Executive Director

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# LEADERSHIP

## Board of Directors



Dr. Ryan N.S. Topping



Brian Holdsworth



Dr. Celene Sidloski



Damein Zakordonski



Caleb Ropp

## Patron



His Eminence Thomas Cardinal Collins

## Advisory Board



Alane Boudreau
*Founding Board Member of the St. John Choir Schola, Calgary*



Dr. Keith Cassidy
*Past President and Chair of the Board of Seat of Wisdom College*



Jeff Lockert
*President, CCO Canada*



Fr Dcn Andrew Bennett
*Executive Director Clear Water Academy, Calgary*

## Fellows



Dr. Joe Woodard
**Calgary**



Mark Ingham (PhD. Cand)
**Barry's Bay**



Ian Mahood
**Edmonton**



Dr. Celene Sidloski
**Saskatoon**



Fr. Michael Bombak
**Toronto**

## Staff

Dr. Ryan N.S. Topping
**Executive Director**

Catherine Renneberg
**Director of Programs**

Victor Carpay
**Development and Communications**

Chaplain: Fr. Frank Sharma, OCD

## SUBCOMMITTEES

### Fundraising

Chair: Caleb Ropp
Vice-Chair: Evan Ropp
Secretary: Jesse Underwood
Member: Kyle King
Member: Annie Engler

### Programs

Chair: Dr. Celene Sidloski
Secretary: Nicholas Kunysz
Member: Brian Holdsworth
Member: Patrick Schiller
Member: Peter Csillag

# Meet the Interns



Beth Kaup



Ben Connolly



Ianua Robertson



Joseph Topping



Christopher Connelly

# Their Mission

The Gregory the Great Institute Summer Internship program ran from May to end of July, 2026. There were five interns with an Intern Director, Beth Kaup, and Intern Co-director, Ben Conolly. The program gave these young Catholics the opportunity to help with the work of bringing cultural renewal to Canada. This was done through evangelization, event planning, communications, fundraising, volunteering, leadership training, and practical ministry experience throughout parishes.

# Highlights

Music and Leadership Camp

- At this year's Gregory the Great Music and Leadership Camp, interns worked as counsellors. This role included running games, leading campfires, leading prayer, learning and teaching music, helping with food, giving talks, and performing skits.

Faith and Reason Seminar

- Interns assisted with music, logistical tasks, and were also able to participate fully in our annual intellectual retreat. For many of the interns, this was the highlight of their summer.

Personal Growth Plans

- At the beginning of the internship, each intern considered their spiritual, intellectual, pastoral, and personal formation, and named goals for each as part of their work with the Institute this summer.

Gianna Centre and Madonna House

- Two of the ministries where the interns served were the Gianna Centre (serving mothers in distress) and the Marian Centre (serving inner city people).

# Numbers

**5** Interns

**12** Weeks

**3** Major Events Supported

**6** Partner Organizations Served

**5** Social Media Projects

**6** Parishes Visited

**~400** Hours Served




**2.5 M+** Viewers of new YouTube series: *Reasonable Passions*



**240+** Renewing Culture Conference Attendees



**500+** Attendees at Lectures




Mailing list has grown by **350%**



**100+** *Inklings groups* gathered for book studies



**40** Students at our Masterclass



**60** St. Gregory's Folk Music Camp participants



**40** Leaders attending Seminars



**30** Couples at our Marriage Retreat



**5** Interns helping lead camps and retreats

# 2026 TIMELINE



**JANUARY** 01

**$205K Pledged**

*Magnalia* published & sent to every bishop in the country



**FEBRUARY** 02

**First Marriage Retreat**

"Searching for and Maintaining Peace" Book Study

**GGI invited to Friends In the New Evangelization (FINE) Conference in Ottawa**

**MARCH** 03

**Dr. Topping Delivers the Keith Cassidy Lecture at Seat of Wisdom College**








**APRIL** 04

**First Master Class**



**MAY** 05

**Hired 5 Interns**

C-YEG Pilgrimage Lecture BBQ

**"Animal Farm" Book Study**





**JUNE** 06

**Faith and Reason Seminar**

**St. Gregory's Music and Leadership Camp**

New YouTube Series "Reasonable Passions" Launched

JULY 07











AUGUST 08

**GGI Proposes 2027 Major Launch Plans to the Board;** Website and CRM are Upgraded



**GGI's 1st Birthday Party**

**"Leisure: The Basis of Culture" Book Study**

**2nd Annual Board Retreat**

SEPTEMBER 09





OCTOBER 10

**2nd Annual Renewing Culture Conference**



**Begin Hosting Supporter Nights across Western Canada**

NOVEMBER 11



DECEMBER 12

**Volume 2 of Magnalia is Published**

# Testimonials

"The Institute is helping us to understand that the root of Catholic culture begins primarily in the home, in how we live and raise our children; only when it is rooted in the domestic church can it spread to the world. When we attended the Institute's Marriage Retreat we were blessed to hear how other parents cultivate faith in their homes, and this made us realize that, although we may not be called to go out and do heroic deeds of cultural renewal, we can contribute to the growth of Catholic Culture in our little way—by praying and going to Mass together, celebrating feast days, learning beautiful music, and reading good books to our children."

**Jackie and Reid Richard**

Marriage Retreat Attendees





"Through the moments of faith and friendship [at the Music and Leadership Camp], a renewal of culture started to expand in my mind, heart, and soul. Having wholesome fun with people of all ages refreshes the foundation of your being. Whether singing at the top of your lungs, crawling on the grass during Mission Impossible, creating skits based on a proverb, dancing to live folk songs, running full speed during capture the flag, crafting a bouquet, or doing chores as a group, earthly tasks were suddenly touched by the divine. Slowly and gently, my heart was caught up in the glorious melody of living fully alive in the Body of Christ. I will never be the same after tasting these goods and basking in the joys of such friendship. I can't wait to experience more of what this Institute has to offer."

**Vanessa Montpetit**

Music and Leadership Camp Attendee



"For young adults like me, Gregory the Great Institute provides an opportunity to experience an intentional and nurturing culture. To mature in a society that lacks any desire to draw out beauty from our lives, I think people my age can tend to feel orphaned; lacking direction, but desiring higher delights that we are not able to grasp alone. GGI is putting forth massive effort to give us that direction, so that our regular, everyday lives are imbued with meaning and discipleship. For me, it is encouraging to know that some people still care about making our modern culture one that uplifts rather than stifles what is good in man."

**Suzannah Oschner**

Master Class attendee



"The Institute introduced me to the idea that Catholic Culture is not just a set of traditions or practices, but is a culture that predisposes us to be transformed in the likeness of God. I got this idea when Dr. Topping described the three modes of life at one of his talks. Overall, Catholic Culture is an environment where we can easily participate in God's plan and are more inclined to receive, with gratitude and yearning, the graces which God bestows upon us. I believe that the work of Dr. Topping and his colleagues will bear great fruit in Canada. Forming the minds of young men and women like me to think and act like virtuous Catholics will bring about holy clergymen, ordered families, and altruistic leaders in the future."

**Xavier Villar**

Friend of the Institute

"I've been a believer in the Institute since its conception; being surrounded by the Institute's messaging and face-to-face with the people it serves proved to me how much demand there is for the kinds of renewal we advocate for."

**Benjamin Connolly**

Co-Director of the 2026 Internship



Join the Mission

# Where Do You Fit In?

Choose your role in renewing Catholic culture in Canada

## Friend of the Institute

$15+ /month ($180+/year)

Join the growing community sustaining Catholic cultural renewal

• Monthly prayer inclusion • *Magnalia* digital edition (PDF) • Early event registration

## Patron

$50+ /month ($600+/year)

The backbone of the Institute

• Everything in Friend, plus:
• *Magnalia* print subscription
• Conference early-bird + 10% discount

## Leadership Circle

$5,000+ /year

Leaders of the future of Catholic culture in Canada

Take the next step in forming Canadian culture.

## Visionary Partner

$25,000+ /year

Strategic partners in shaping what comes next

If you see the future of Catholic intellectual life in Canada and want to help build it, we'd welcome a conversation.




**Support Needs:**
**$350,000 to equip the next generation of leaders. Help us renew culture!**

gregorythegreat.ca/support




# Looking Ahead

## *Goals for 2027*

Gregory the Great Institute is a non-profit with a big vision for renewal. It has been awe-inspiring to see how the Institute has begun to equip hundreds of people already in its first year, but much work remains. In the upcoming year we plan to realize the following goals:

*Raise*

**$350,000**

*in donations for 2027 Budget*

### *Continue Expanding and Delivering Programs*

- Announce 2027 Major Program
- Publications
- Seminars
- Conferences

*Serve*

| | |
|---|---|
| 160 | Book Studies |
| 100 | Young Catholics in courses and camps |
| 1,000 | Leaders in seminars, conferences, & lectures |
| 10,000 | Readers of articles & new journal *Magnalia* |
| 3 Million | Viewers of new YouTube series |

Your support will ensure the Institute realizes these goals and continues to share the riches of the Faith without compromise.

*Thank you for your generous support in renewing culture in Canada!*

# 2026 Facts & Figures

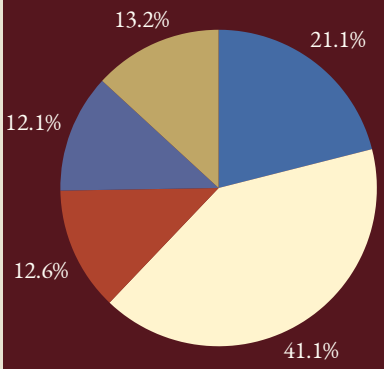
## *Total Gifts for our 2026 Budget*

| | |
|---|---|
| Donations | $265,000 |
| Grants | $52,000 |
| Sponsorships | $25,000 |

## *Total Donors to Present*

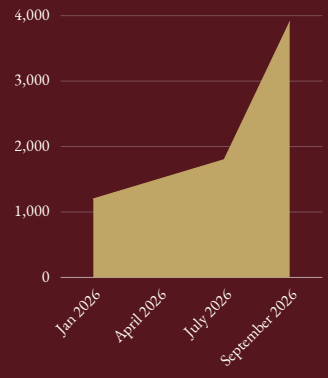
**190**

## *Donors by Region*




Edmonton: 21.1%
Rest of AB: 41.1%%
Calgary: 12.6%
Saskatchewan: 12.1%
Rest of CAD: 13.2%

## *Growth in Mailing List*




## *Number of People in Governance or Operations*

**25**

# Our Vision

The Gregory the Great Institute
is a registered charity that equips
Christians to renew culture in
the light of faith and reason
through formation programs,
courses, and publications that
focus on Catholic life in Canada.

To join our mission by offering a donation,
visit our website or scan this code:

www.GregoryTheGreat.ca